ANA ARMENDARIZ

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PhD candidate in Econometrics working on causal inference, treatment effect estimation and policy learning, in both experimental and observational settings. Python, SQL, R.

EDUCATION

PhD in Economics and Econometrics (specialisation: Econometrics), University of St Gallen, Switzerland Aug 2023 – Expected July 2027
Swiss Institute for Empirical Economic Research (SEW). Supervisor: Prof. Dr. Michael Lechner.

Master in Data Analytics and Economics, University of Fribourg, Switzerland 2021 – 2023
GPA: 5.35/6, *magna cum laude*

Bachelor in Economics, Universidad de las Américas, Ecuador 2017 – 2021
GPA: 3.7/4

SKILLS

Programming	Python (NumPy, pandas, scikit-learn, PyTorch), SQL, R, Git, Stata
Methods	Causal inference and treatment effect estimation, causal machine learning (causal forests, double machine learning), policy learning, heterogeneous treatment effects, experimental and quasi-experimental design, hypothesis testing, high-dimensional inference
Languages	Spanish (native), English (C1), French (B2), Russian (B1), German (A2)

RESEARCH

Testing Effect Homogeneity and Confounding in High-Dimensional Experimental and Observational Studies. *With Martin Huber.* arXiv:2602.19703. We propose a framework for testing the homogeneity of conditional average treatment effects (CATEs) across multiple experimental and observational studies, using double machine learning to handle high-dimensional covariates.

Overfitting in Policy Learning. *With Michael Lechner & Jana Marečková.* We propose a method to detect overfitting in policy learning models and develop tools to help applied researchers mitigate this issue.

Placebo-based Diagnostics for Heterogeneous Treatment Effects. *With Linda Odermatt, Michael Lechner & Jana Marečková.* We develop a sensitivity analysis tool for applied researchers which makes minimal parametric assumptions.

Impact Evaluation of Drug Consumption Rooms on Health and Criminal Outcomes. *Single author.* This study estimates the causal impact of the availability of Drug Consumption Rooms on health outcomes related to drug use, using a staggered difference-in-differences design on the universe of hospitalisations in Switzerland. Funded by the Swiss Society of Health Economics.

EXPERIENCE

Doctoral Researcher / Research Assistant August 2023 – Present
Swiss Institute for Empirical Economic Research, University of St Gallen *St Gallen, Switzerland*

- Developed documentation and testing frameworks for mcf, an open-source Python package for Modified Causal Forests used to estimate heterogeneous treatment effects.
- Teaching Assistant: Causal Machine Learning (PhD level) & Microeconometrics (Master's level).

Visiting PhD Researcher February 2026 – July 2026
Universidad Autónoma de Madrid *Madrid, Spain*
Six-month visit funded by a competitive SNSF DocMobility grant (CHF 22,600). Hosted by the Departamento de Análisis Económico under the supervision of Eugenio Zucchelli, Jorge García Hombrados & Ana Nuevo Chiquero.

Research Assistant July 2022 – October 2022
Chair of Applied Econometrics and Policy Evaluation, University of Fribourg *Fribourg, Switzerland*
Supervisor: Prof. Dr. Martin Huber. Contributed to editing and implementing referee report revisions.

Innovation Lab Officer June 2022 – June 2023
Fribourg School of Management *Fribourg, Switzerland*
Designed and developed a mobile app to monitor affiliated startups (view app).

Junior Analyst August 2019 – June 2020
Vamos Pasajes *Quito, Ecuador*
Created automated reports and KPIs to streamline data analysis and decision-making.

CONFERENCES & PRESENTATIONS

2026: EuHEA (Rotterdam) · IAAE, *session chair* (Portugal) · 3rd Workshop on the Economics of Health and Human Capital (Madrid) · CSS Health Economics Workshop (Lucerne) · Congress of the Asociación de Economía del Ecuador (Quito) · Research Seminar, Universidad Autónoma de Madrid · HERB, University of Bologna

AWARDS & GRANTS

DocMobility Grant (CHF 22,600), Swiss National Science Foundation — October 2025
PhD Project Fund (CHF 770), Swiss Society of Health Economics — June 2025
Aschinger Prize for Latin American Academic Achievement, University of Fribourg — September 2023
José Corsino Cárdenas Research Prize (second place), Central Bank of Ecuador — April 2021
Honor Roll, Universidad de las Américas — Spring 2020 & Autumn 2021
Summer School Scholarship, Yale University — August 2019

ADDITIONAL TRAINING

Machine Learning for Treatment Effects and Structural Equation Models, Study Center Gerzensee August 2024
Winter School in Data Analytics & Machine Learning, University of Fribourg — February 2022

VOLUNTEERING

Workshop Instructor, Fundación Avanzar — April 2026 – Present
Designed and delivered workshops on costs and budgeting for women entrepreneurs from vulnerable backgrounds.